

Psalms 59

Deliver Me from Mine Enemies

Deliver me from mine enemies, O my God

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Deliver me from mine enemies, O my God: defend me from them that rise up against me.*
- 2 *Deliver me from the workers of iniquity, and save me from bloody men.*
- 3 *For, lo, they lie in wait for my soul: the mighty are gathered against me; not for my transgression, nor for my sin, O LORD.*
- 4 *They run and prepare themselves without my fault: awake to help me, and behold.*
- 5 *Thou therefore, O LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel, awake to visit all the heathen: be not merciful to any wicked transgressors. Selah.*
- 6 *They return at evening: they make a noise like a dog, and go round about the city.*
- 7 *Behold, they belch out with their mouth: swords are in their lips: for who, say they, doth hear?*
- 8 *But thou, O LORD, shalt laugh at them; thou shalt have all the heathen in derision.*
- 9 *Because of his strength will I wait upon thee: for God is my defence.*
- 10 *The God of my mercy shall prevent me: God shall let me see my desire upon mine enemies.*
- 11 *Slay them not, lest my people forget: scatter them by thy power; and bring them down, O Lord our shield.*
- 12 *For the sin of their mouth and the words of their lips let them even be taken in their pride: and for cursing and lying which they speak.*
- 13 *Consume them in wrath, consume them, that they may not be: and let them know that God ruleth in Jacob unto the ends of the earth. Selah.*
- 14 *And at evening let them return; and let them make a noise like a dog, and go round about the city.*
- 15 *Let them wander up and down for meat, and grudge if they be not satisfied.*
- 16 *But I will sing of thy power; yea, I will sing aloud of thy mercy in the morning: for thou hast been my defence and refuge in the day of my trouble.*
- 17 *Unto thee, O my strength, will I sing: for God is my defence, and the God of my mercy.*

2 · CONTEXT

Superscription connects this to Saul's men surrounding David's house to kill him (1 Sam 19:11). The psalm alternates between describing prowling enemies "like a dog" circling the city at night and confident declarations of God as defense and refuge. Henry notes the refrain repeated with growing certainty—from watching enemies at evening to singing of God's power in the morning.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-5

"Deliver me from mine enemies, O my God... defend me from them that rise up against me." Mighty men gather without cause; David protests his innocence and calls on the "LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel" to awake, behold, and visit all the heathen.

Verse 6-10

The enemies are pictured as dogs: "they return at evening: they make a noise like a dog, and go round about the city." Yet David will "wait upon thee," confident "the God of my mercy shall prevent me"—go before him with help.

Verse 11-13

A prayer that God not slay them outright but let them wander, so that people "may know that God ruleth in Jacob unto the ends of the earth"—judgment serves as public testimony, not mere personal relief.

Verse 14-17

The dog-like prowling returns at evening, yet the psalm closes in triumphant contrast: "But I will sing of thy power... for God is my defence, and the God of my mercy." The same nightly threat that opened in fear closes surrounded by song.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Real, prowling danger does not have the last word when God is named "defence" and "God of my mercy"—the psalm shows how the same threatening scene can be reframed by unwavering trust from crisis into praise.

Application for life today.

When you feel surrounded or watched by hostility, name specific threats honestly to God rather than only enduring silently. Let "I will wait upon thee" be an active, not passive, posture—expectant rather than resigned. Practice ending prayer, even mid-crisis, with declared trust ("I will sing of thy power") rather than only petition.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What "dogs... round about the city" (recurring threats or anxieties) circle you at "evening," and how do you usually respond?

2. How does calling God your "defence" and "the God of my mercy" reframe a current fear?

3. What would it look like to move, like this psalm, from crisis language in the morning to song by evening?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).